

Monthly Protection Overview – August 2024 – Ethiopia

Part 1

Attacks on civilians <i>(including humanitarian workers and civilian infrastructures/facilities)</i>	Amhara	The ongoing conflict in the Amhara region has increased the humanitarian crisis, with attacks on civilians, including Kidnappings, killings of both civilians and humanitarian workers. The conflict has led to the destruction of infrastructure and public institutions; victims include Humanitarian workers, Refugees and IDPs
	Gambella	In August, a total of 3 individuals were killed and 1 other individual was wounded by Unknown armed groups in Dimma, Gog and Itang special woredas.
	Somali	Ethic conflict - Disputes over land ownership and other natural resources resulted ethnic fighting communities in Darimi kebele of Tuliguled Woreda, Fafan zone was reported. According to the reports, around 5-7 individuals were killed, and unknown number of individuals were injured. - In Siti Zone, a total of 92,710 IDPs in, out of which 42,300 are conflict related, 8,717 climates induced and 41,700 drought-induced are displaced. The key needs are food, shelter, NFI, health, nutrition, Protection, and education. Response is still limited.
	Tigray	In August, there were no reports of attacks on civilians.
New displacements <i>(specify the reason for displacement)</i>	Amhara	New IDP's to South Wollo and North Shewa (1520 new IDPs from Oromia), DebreBirhan. Due to the restriction on registration of new arrival of IDPs, the numbers in South Wollo are not known. It is reported that part of the new arrivals (154) are those who returned to Oromia through the government led return exercise.
	Somali	Floods-Afder, Shabelle, and Siti - Shabelle and Weib rivers flooded and affected the flood-prone locations. Over 113,000, were affected and more than 25,000 displaced. In Shabelle, flood affected 14,215 households (over 85,000 people) were affected of which 4,160 households (more than 24,000 people) were displaced in three woredas of the Shabelle zone (Kalafo, Mustahil, and Fer-fer). - The flood hit four woredas in Afder zone and over 27,000 people (4500 households. Over 900 individuals displaced, and 180 homes destroyed with three human death and five injuries across five floods affected kebeles in Gablalu Siti zone.
	Tigray	Due to a landslide, 26 households (136 people) in Enderta Woreda in the Southeastern zone, 28 households (101 people) in Geter Adwa Woreda in the Central zone, and 479 households (2,000 people) in Selewa Woreda in the Southern zone have been displaced, affecting a total of 2,237 individuals. Additionally, four people have died because of the landslide in Atsibi and Hintalo Woredas.

	Gambella	A total of 5,788HHs comprising of 28,495 individuals were displaced in 8 woredas of Gambella region due to seasonal flood.
	Oromia	Due the flood and land slide 54 HH and 342 individuals were displaced to nearby kebeles in 4 woredas namely Goro Gutu, Girawa, Deder and Malka Bello woredas of East Hararghe zone. The death of 6 individuals were reported in Deder woreda as a result of flood
Returns, relocations, and durable solutions	Amhara	Due to the rainy season, there is no return exercise in the region.
	Somali	- Development Finance Specialist, Office of UN Special Advisor to Secretary General on Solutions to Internally Displacement Persons, visited the Somali regional state and had meetings with regional government/DRMB, office of the president, durable solutions working group, UN, and NGO partners at Jigjiga level to discuss the overall humanitarian situations and IDP solutions. - The mission visited Goljano relocation site where some IDPs from Qoloji have been relocated to and Qoloji IDP camp community members. The team discussed with community, government, and partners on planned relocations, relocated IDPs and local integrations to support IDPs durable solutions.
	Tigray	- A government-led returnee exercise was conducted for IDPs from the Adigrat IDP sites, including the Finote Brhan site, where a total of 1,243 individuals comprising 277 households were returned to their places of origin (Laelay Tselemiti, Tahtay Tselemiti, and Maytsebri). - There is no humanitarian assistance available for returnees in the southern zone. The recent returnees to Alamata and Raya Alamata have not received any humanitarian support, increasing their protection risks, particularly in areas where humanitarians have limited access.
Socio-economic developments (if applicable)	Amhara	Due to the ongoing conflict and continuous roadblocks, there are shortage of supplies commodities resulting in increased prices
	Oromia	East/West Hararghe: With the rising cost of living and lack of food assistance the IDP are finding it hard to support to meet their basic needs.
	Somali	High prices as a result of the inflation. Community reported vulnerabilities and lack of economic capacity to avail basic services as result. Youth migration into Djibouti, Somalia and Saudi Arabia, street begging increase, school dropouts, children working to contribute to household incomes
	Tigray	- A multi-sectoral assessment was conducted from July 28 to August 3, 2024, to evaluate the overall security situation, humanitarian access, and road conditions in Alamata town and Raya Alamata. The assessment aimed to identify risks, protection needs, and the feasibility of safely returning internally displaced persons (IDPs). It also involved an inter-regional evaluation of humanitarian needs, available services, and response priorities in contested areas and IDP sites, including Alamata, Raya Alamata, Korem, Ofla, Zata, and Chercher. - IOM facilitated the administrative and finance procedures for the incoming consultative workshop on the Kebele ID roll-out in Tigray. - According to the Ethiopian Immigration and Citizenship Service, the Mekele branch office began offering new passport services on August 19, 2024.

		- Despite continuous advocacy efforts with Adigrat University, the MoU has not been signed with the University. - Housing and land property (HLP) issues have not been resolved through the court system; only identification and registration have been carried out. - The GBV AoR partners celebrated Ashenda with a focus on GBV prevention. Their activities included campaigns across various platforms, distribution of items by partners, panel discussions, and other related events.
Drought/flood highlights <i>(if applicable)</i>	Amhara	- The hulederie Worda of South Wollo Zone, 19 Houses Damaged and Individuals Affected and 50Household materials and belongings were either destroyed, leaving many families without Household materials and belongings were either destroyed, leaving many families without essential items and shelter. Telemet, Adi Arkay, Beyeda and Janamora woredas North Gondar. A landslide caused a crack on the residential, farming and grazing communal area and damaged residential houses, killed civilians and livestock. Approximately 23 people and 318 livestock death reported, 8 severely injured, and 2949 people (650 households) were evacuated, and are now temporarily residing at neighbours, relatives, primary School, and Ethiopian Orthodox Church compounds. Moreover, about 1775.5 hectare of crop field is fully damaged.
	Oromia	East/West Hararghe woredas were affected by flood, hailstorm, and land slide. - Goro Muti, Kersa, Deder, Kurfa Chele and Melka Bello woredas were affected by flood resulting in significant loss of production, livestock and 6 persons death in Deder woreda. - Two woredas Goro Gutu, Meta and Girawa were affected by landslide resulting in production loss, damages to shelter. - Hailstorm was reported in Goro Gutu woreda causing damage to 440 hectares of crop. - Drought continues affecting a lot of woredas in East and West Hararghe zones. Due to the lack of rain in the previous Belg season poor production. Production loss is expected from 58 % and 51 % (Source Belg assessment
	Somali	
	Tigray	- The ongoing heavy rain damages shelters in IDP sites, some IDPs have nothing to shelter in, and elders, women, and children need urgent shelter and blanket assistance in the rainy and cold weather. - Limited access and availability of agricultural inputs (esp. seeds including forage seeds) in the region. - Limited supply of animal vaccines and treatment drugs. - Flooding was reported from different woredas, with three deaths in Raya Azebo and Gerelata Woredas. A cholera outbreak across various woredas in Tigray is posing serious protection risks for both host communities and IDP sites. A total of 374 individuals have been reportedly affected by the disease, with 8 deaths.
	Gambella	Seasonal flooding has displaced 5,788HHs consisting of 28,495 individuals and affected a total of 8,046 HHs consisting of 41,704 individuals in 8 woredas of the region. (Source: Flood assessment report by Gambella regional Disaster Risk Management service (DRMS), The seasonal flooding caused by overflow of major rivers has also caused widespread damages to homes, assets and infrastructures which can exacerbate protection risks to the displaced people.

Access to fundamental rights and basic services

Item	Please use the drop-down menu	Please briefly explain
Did the access situation by protection actors to affected population improved, remained similar or deteriorated? (compared with the last reporting period)	Access situation improved	Gambella: Significant decrease of security incidents has been witnessed in the region. Tigray: IDP return exercise officially conducted by the regional government to four kebeles of Tselemti woreda (Maiayni, Maianbesa, Wehedet, and Medhenalem). The contested areas in the southern zone are currently accessible.
	Access situation remained similar	Amhara: Due to the ongoing conflict and the deteriorated security situation, access problems remain similar. Somali: Due to security related matters, the humanitarian agencies are not reaching the affected communities in Daymed and Dhunyar (the two new woredas) in Siti zone.
	Access situation deteriorated	East/West Hararghe
Please list and explain the most critical barriers for protection actors to access to affected population	On-going insecurity or hostilities affecting humanitarian assistance (incl. presence of ERWs)	Amhara: On going conflict and presence of armed actors near to IDP site in Kuatabaer IDP site in South Wollo zone makes access impossible for protection actors to reach affected areas. Gambella: Recurrent tribal conflict and UAG attacks are the most critical barriers for protection actors to access affected populations.
	Environmental and logistical constraints	East/West Hararghe: Due to the rain some kebeles with bad road condition are difficult for partners to access
	Other, please specify	Tigray: Shelter in most IDP sites is damaged, reconstruction is urgently needed. ▪ Limited funding for program operations and IDP demands. ▪ Limited opportunities to earn a sustainable livelihood and economic empowerment. Lack of humanitarian assistance in contested areas in both the Northwest and Southern zones.
Did the access situation for affected populations to protection services improved, remained similar, or deteriorated? (compared with the last reporting period)	Access situation improved	Gambella: The current security situation is relatively permissive for humanitarian activities
	Access situation remained similar	Somali: In Siti, access to affected population in the affected areas remain critical. With the recent ceasefire agreement, some locations may be accessible.
	Access situation deteriorated	
	Ongoing insecurity or hostilities	Amhara: The cost of accessing services, including transportation, fees, and lost income from taking time off work prohibitive for

Please list and explain the most critical barriers for affected populations to access protection services:		affected individuals and remote or conflict-affected areas have limited or no access to protection services. Physical distance and lack of transportation make it difficult for individuals to reach service providers; Lack of awareness and information on available protection services or how to access them. Inadequate service provision the services due to lack of resources, trained personal appropriate facilities. Gambella: Significant decrease of tribal conflict has been witnessed during August.
	Unavailability of protection services	East/West Hararghe: Lack of protection partners Somali: Limited protection partners presence in most of the IDP sites.
	Other, please specify	Tigray: Due to heavy rain, Shelter in IDP sites have been damaged, reconstruction is urgently needed especially in SC-4 and Quiha IDP sites; The recent returnees to Alamata and Raya Alamata have not received any humanitarian support and it increases their protection risks; Limited Partners Presence in most critical areas in need of services e.g contested areas; Limited funding :Partners not able to meet the needs of children;
With whom has the Protection Cluster/AoR consistently engaged on access for protection (during this reporting period)?	OCHA	Tigray: The forum is functional under OCHA leadership where all humanitarian partners are engaged in information exchanges and production of access mapping and issues related to negotiation
	National or local authorities	Gambella: Gambella Sub-National protection cluster is liaising with Bureau of women and social affairs (BoWSA) and disaster risk management service (DRMS) for protection.
	Coordination forum (e.g. Access WG, CM Coord, other)	Amhara: With OCHA and other UN agencies. Including different coordination platforms for further advocacy.
	International NGOs	East/West Hararghe
	Others (please specify)	Somali: Regional authorities, UN, INGOs/LNGOs, coordination, WGs.

Service/need	Region/woreda(s)	Population affected	Relevant changes during the month in the access to fundamental right / basic service and impact on the affected population
Child Protection services	Amhara		- During the month under review a total of 85,000 children were reached by partners in services including case management, MHPSS, need based support to UASC, awareness raising to mitigate SGBV, provision of dignity kits cash assistance and other supports. - Efforts are also underway to establish coordination mechanism in western part of Amhara in zones severely impacted by conflict and other calamities.

			The CP AoR in close collaboration with the GBV AoR have continued to technically support zonal BoWCSA, to ensure the latter take their leading role as the main government counterpart. - It also ensured that CP issues were assessed in the recently conducted MIRA in contested areas of the region. A vulnerability assessment was conducted with the help of the regional Bureau of Women, Children and Social affairs and their respective zonal structures. The preliminary report indicates that close to 800,000 children have been identified from all zones with different types of vulnerabilities. The final report is to be shared soon so that partners will use it to advocate. - UNICEF deployed a child protection in emergency consultant to support the response in North Shewa.
Child Protection services	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	IDPs in sites	Children are migrating to nearby towns to beg, or work support their family. Given the food insecurity and the lack of assistance these children may not enroll into school the coming academic year has been reported in East Hararghe.
Child Protection services	Somali	IDPs	There is a growing number of unaccompanied and separated children in border areas affected by conflicts. Many unaccompanied and separated children who lost their parents in recent communal conflicts are living with extended relatives as there are no formal foster care arrangements.
Child Protection services	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	A high prevalence of child marriages, widespread child labor in the agricultural sector, rampant transactional sex involving individuals under 18 in townships, and significant child trafficking concerns in Saudi Arabia. - CP AoR's mission to the Northwestern Zone has identified several critical issues: UASC in need of support, orphan, and other vulnerable children (Street children, Children with HIV/Aids, children who are engaged in commercial sex), SGBV survivors, the potential presence of Explosive ordinance. - The presence of CP partners in the Southern and Northwestern regions remains very limited, particularly in the former contested areas that are now accessible. - Weak or non-existent protection mechanisms in return locations increase risks for children and other vulnerable groups.
Civil documentation	Somali	IDPs	
Education	Tigray / Southern zone	IDPs and host communities	
Food and nutrition	Oromia / East Hararghe zone	IDPs in sites	IDPs in collective sites are excluded from food assistance. It has been nearly two years since the IDPs received food in Deder. The other woredas it is close to one year since they received food assistance. The IDPs are feeling helpless and psychologically stressed and struggling to support their families

Food and nutrition	Tigray	IDPs and host communities/ the whole community	• Negative coping mechanisms continue because of a lack of access to basic needs. • Limited access and availability of agricultural inputs (esp. seeds including forage seeds) in the region.
GBV core services	Amhara	IDPs	• In Amhara services across multiple woredas are ongoing, providing critical GBV services, including case management, psychosocial support, and awareness activities. • Finalized the establishment and update of GBV referral pathways in 35 woredas to facilitate access to services including, medical, safety/security and legal support. • A new safe house is established in Kombolcha by AWSAD providing accommodation and comprehensive GBV services for survivors. • A new OSC is established by WVI in Kombolcha Hospital which will provide comprehensive services to survivors within the TA and nearby woredas.
GBV core services	Oromia / West Hararghe zone	All	• In West Hararghe 4 physical violence, 4 rape, 2 attempted rape, 8 bigamy, 1 killing spouse, 2 killings and one abandoning newborn, 5 human trafficking were reported by the Women and children's Affairs office.
GBV core services	Somali	IDPs	• Women and girls face higher risks of SGBV due to the increased distances they travel to fetch water and firewood, adolescent girls working as housekeepers in the bigger cities, traveling alone while looking after animals specially during the drought seasons. • Increase of GBV cases
GBV core services IGA/livelihood for GBv survivors/people at risks of GBV	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• Due to the rainy season, Women and Girls Safe Spaces (WGSS) centers in Abiadi and Maichew have been damaged, leading to a suspension of daily activities. • The GBV AoR assessment of the Southern Zone found that many women and girls are exposed to various forms of gender-based violence and are resorting to negative coping mechanisms, such as forced marriage and child labor. • Child marriage is highly prevalent, as indicated by the reports received from partners. • Many women and girls are also at increased risk due to the loss of shelter resulting from flooding and this poses a risk factor for exposure to GBV. • The project on GBV programming for WGFS implemented in 8 weredas by I1D is being phased out, covering areas such as Mekelle Seba care camp, Maichew, Adigrat, Axum, AbiyAdi and Shire.
Health services	Amhara		• During the reporting month, Cholera outbreak was reported in different places of the region, especially in Central, North and West Gondor.
Health services	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	IDPs in sites	• Increasing numbers of malnutrition cases were reported. Public health emergency is a primary concern in both zones. Cholera, Malaria and Measles are spreading in the zones.

Health services	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• Low WASH and sanitation facility in health facilities of Raya Azebo, Chercher, Ofra, Endamokeni, and 20 Adi wojerat. (Belg Assessment) • Lack of SC service in most of health centers. (Belg Assessment) • Lack of transport and ambulance, mothers die during delivery reported at chercher and 20 adi wajrat (tsehafti kebele). (Belg Assessment) • Outbreak of zoonotic diseases, particularly rabies, poses a significant threat to both animals and humans, further exacerbated by the absence of effective control measures. • There is a reported increase in the spread of HIV/AIDS in Tigray region.
Land marking and clearance form ERWs	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• In Chercher woreda, 34 Explosives ordnance devices were collected from the communities and handed over to the local police for further demolition session. • With the new funding, RaDO deployed EORE teams in Central and NorthWestern zone.
Shelter/NFI	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• The shelters of IDPs in the Shire AoR have been badly affected by extreme weather events in Asgede, Shire, Tahtay Adiyabo, Adi Daero, and Seyemti Adiyabo. Urgent repairs are needed in various locations. • Similarly shelters in Mekelle and Adigrat need maintenance. • According to the ES/NFI cluster around 4,900 Shelters require immediate maintenance in Shire alone.
WASH	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	IDPs in sites	• Limited WASH partners, shortage of cholera medications and water treatment chemicals and limited access to clean water are contributing to the spread of cholera. Due to the drought some woreda have limited access to water.
MHPSS	Somali		• All the assessments reported family separation, the presence of unaccompanied children and elderly. There are concerns of mental health and psychosocial support needs

Part 2

AoR/WG	Child Protection (CP)
Main Achievements	• UNICEF is Working on a study on the impact of child marriage, FGM, Violence Against Children, and teenage pregnancies in humanitarian situation funded by ESARO under Child Frontiers. data collection is ongoing in Shebelle Zone of Somali Region and in East and West Hararghe Zones of Oromia. • UNICEF is Working with UNDP on a proposal for the UK under the UN trust foundation to support the children and women in the demobilization and integration. • 107 UASC were provided with alternative care arrangements. Amhara, 86 (44 girls, 42 boys), BG 14 (12 girls, two boys), hawassa 85 (26 girls,59 boys) Tigray 7 (2 boys and 5 girls) • In Geze Goffa woreda due to this landslide emergency A total of 177 children (91 girls) have been identified and registered, including 16 children (9 girls) who have lost both parents, 108 children (55 girls) who have lost their fathers, and 53 children (27 girls) who have lost their mothers.

	With UNICEF's support, BoWCA deployed 12 Community-Based Social Services Workers (5 female) and 1 Social Work Supervisor for the landslide emergency response in Geze Gofa Woreda to support case management at IDP sites. Moreover, set up two child-friendly spaces and deployed six CFS (Child-Friendly Spaces) facilitators.
Total People reached – SADD. Please specify the regions and type of services provided if information is available	- Total Reached for GBV AOR: 9460 individuals, including women, girls, men, and boys, accessed core GBV services and information in the reporting period. (Women: 5888, Girls (under 18): 1278, Men: 1665, Boys (under 18): 372, Persons with Disabilities: 257; More than six partners in Tigray are phasing out, Tigray CM TW is deactivated, and discussion points will be discussed through the bi-weekly regional CP AoR meetings. Staff turnover, and case management handover has become challenging; while BoWCA has no capacity to manage the case load. West Gojam, W Gondar, S Gondar, and E Gojam in Amara have high targets, but no partners
Main Challenges and Gaps	FTS shows on 3% funded for CP AOR. Phasing out of more than six partners in Tigray; Trained Staff turnover BoWCA has no capacity to manage the case load.
Underserved locations	Locations that are planned for 2024 but have no partners and no target reached: Western Amhara zones of West, East, North Gojjams and Awi zones, South Gondar, and Oromo special zone. IDP camps in Debre Birhan, North and South wollo remain facing various challenges which are exacerbating child protection and GBV risks. West Gojam, W Gondar, S Gondar, and E Gojam in Amara. These zones have high targets, but no partners are implementing there.
Main findings (from assessment, protection monitoring, surveys conducted during the reporting period)	UNFPA led field monitoring was conducted in South wollo (dessie and kombolcha) and finding from the mission indicate that the majority of GBV survivors are not accessing services due to stigma, lack of awareness, and lack of timely access to available of support due to security condition. Additionally, women and girls face heightened risks of GBV in IDP camps due to overcrowding, lack of food and other basic services.

AoR/WG	Choose an item.
Main Achievements	

Part 3

Coordination mechanisms and outcomes for the reporting period

Cluster/AoR presence/functioning	Amhara: Both the regional and zonal protection clusters conducted (North Shewa, South and North Wollo and in North Gondor). East/West Hararghe: Two Protection cluster Coordination meetings
Protection Assessments	Amhara: Multi sectoral assessment was conducted in the contested areas, and the protection cluster is part of the assessment. Somali: GU Assessment key protection findings in progress and to be shared this week. Gambella Region Disaster risk management service (DRMS) conducted joint flood assessment in 4 floods affected woredas.
Protection monitoring	Amhara: Protection monitoring and both GBV response and preventing activities have been conducted in all IDP sites. Routine protection monitoring activities conducted at all IDP sites and some of the pressing needs are Food and shelter issues mentioned by IDPs as the most pressing humanitarian needs and the collective sites are observed to be overcrowded without adequate shelter, water, and sanitation facilities. Overcrowded households due to damaged shelters because of flood, heavy rain, and wind. Toilet, and WASH

	facilities also need maintenance. Shortage of multipurpose cash support for GBV survivors and women at risk. Underreporting of GBV incident due to varied reasons. Shortage of the necessary materials and facilities required in the temporary WGFS. Less response for the new arrival of IDPs, in addition to the prolonged IDP situation without any support in Central and North Gondor IDPS East/West Haraghe: The Protection Monitoring Assessment conducted together with IRC, IMC and IOM in East Hararghe was published	
Relevant documents	• Amhara: An advocacy note has been produced and shared with ICCG ad national cluster for advocacy purpose. • Gambella: Region DRMS shared the joint flood assessment report with humanitarian actors requesting humanitarian service for the displaced people. • Tigray: A multi-sectoral assessment was conducted from July 28 to August 3, 2024, to evaluate the overall security situation, humanitarian access, and road conditions in Alamata town and Raya Alamata. The assessment aimed to identify risks, protection needs, and the feasibility of safely returning internally displaced persons (IDPs). It also involved an inter-regional evaluation of humanitarian needs, available services, and response priorities in contested areas and IDP sites, including Alamata, Raya Alamata, Korem, Ofla, Zata, and Chercher. The report to be shared after clearance by EHCT.	
Working Groups, Task Forces, collaborations	Amhara: Durable solutions WG East/West Hararghe: Oromia regional ICCG Gambella: Gambella Sub-National protection cluster attends Gambella region disaster risk management technical working group (DRMTWG) Tigray: Emergency Coordination Center (ECC Tigray Region), Inter-Cluster Coordination Group, Bi-weekly PC Coordination Meeting, Child Protection AoR, Mine Action AoRs, GBV AoR, Housing, Land and Property Technical WG (HLP-TWG), Disability/Inclusion Technical working group	• Amhara: Strategy document developed. • Tigray: In addition to the regular meetings, PC has been involved in Ad-hoc forums, contributing significantly to raising protection concerns and drawing the attention of other cluster leads and partners.